Spicy Italian Sausage Spaghetti-Orzo Soup

with gremolata

Prep Time:

30-40 min

Cook Within:

5 days

Difficulty:

Intermediate

Spice Level:

Spicy

Nutrition (per serving)

Calories: 670

Carbs: 65g

Fat: 33g

Protein: 36g

Sodium: 2150mg

Contains: milk, wheat

Ingredients (Serves 2)

- 8 fl. oz. Tomato Sauce
- 8 oz. Italian Pork Sausage
- 1 Onion
- 1 Lemon
- 4 oz. Carrot & Celery Blend
- 4 oz. Orzo Pasta
- 1 oz. Arrabbiata Pesto
- 1/2 oz. Grated Parmesan Cheese
- 1/2 oz. Parsley
- 2 tsp. Chicken Broth Concentrate
- 2 Garlic Cloves
- 1/4 tsp. Red Pepper Flakes

You'll Need

- 2 Medium Pots
- 1 Mixing Bowl
- 1 Zester
- 1 Plate
- 1 Colander/Strainer

Before You Cook

- Wash hands thoroughly with soap and warm water before cooking and after handling raw meat or seafood
- Remove all produce from any packaging or constraints, then thoroughly rinse and pat dry
- Bring 6 cups water and 1 tsp. salt to a boil in a medium pot
- Ingredient(s) used more than once: lemon, garlic, red pepper flakes

Instructions

1. Cook the Orzo



Once water is boiling, add orzo and cook until al dente, 4-6 minutes.

Remove from burner. Reserve 1 cup orzo cooking water.

Drain orzo in a colander/strainer and rinse under cold water. Set aside.

While orzo cooks, continue recipe.

2. Prepare Ingredients and Make Gremolata



Mince parsley, leaves and stems.

Zest and halve lemon. Cut halves into wedges.

Halve and peel onion. Cut halves into 1/4" dice.

Mince garlic.

In a mixing bowl, combine parsley, half the garlic (reserve remaining for soup), 1 tsp. lemon zest, and a pinch of salt. Set aside.

Remove sausage from casing, if necessary.

Roll sausage into 1-inch meatballs, roughly 12-16 meatballs. Feel free to skip making balls and simply crumble, if desired.

3. Start the Meatballs



Place another medium pot over medium heat and add 2 tsp. olive oil.

Add meatballs to hot pot and cook until browned, 2-3 minutes per side.

If skipping meatballs, add sausage directly to hot pot. Break into 1" pieces until golden and crisp, 4-6 minutes.

Transfer sausage to a plate, reserving rendered fat in pot. Keep pot over medium heat.

Sausage will finish cooking in a later step.

4. Add the Vegetables and Broth



Add onions and carrot and celery blend to hot pot. Stir occasionally until softened, 4-6 minutes.

Stir in remaining garlic and half the red pepper flakes (use less if spice-averse; reserve remaining for garnish) until fragrant, 30-60 seconds.

Stir in chicken base, 2 cups water, tomato sauce, and pesto (to taste), scraping bottom of pot to release any brown bits.

Bring to a simmer.

5. Finish Soup and Finish Dish



Once simmering, add meatballs to hot pot and stir occasionally until sausage reaches a minimum internal temperature of 160 degrees, 5-7 minutes.

Add orzo and stir until combined and heated through, 30-60 seconds.

If too thick, add reserved orzo cooking water, 1 Tbsp. at a time, until desired consistency is reached.

Remove from burner.

Plate dish as pictured on front of card, garnishing with cheese, gremolata, and remaining red pepper flakes (to taste). Squeeze lemon wedges over to taste. Bon appétit!